

NIA MUCHER

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AI Policy · Education Technology

EDUCATION

B.A., Computer Science & History · GPA: 3.86

University of Virginia · Charlottesville, VA

August 2025 – Present

A.S., Computer Science · GPA: 3.91

Northern Virginia Community College · Annandale, VA

September 2023 – May 2025

RESEARCH & POLICY EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant — AI Bias & Education

UVA Engineering, advised by Prof. David Evans · Charlottesville, VA

January 2026 – Present

- ❖ First-authored a paper accepted at AIES 2026 (AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society) presenting an audit framework to detect racial bias in AI image generators, developed with law students to ground it for use in publicly funded institutions.
- ❖ Briefed Albemarle County Public Schools (ACPS) and Canva on audit findings to inform procurement decisions; brokered institutional partnerships with both organizations.

Vice President — Virginia AI Security Initiative

UVA student organization on AI governance & catastrophic risk · Charlottesville, VA

May 2026 – Present

- ❖ Lead a 40+ member student organization focused on AI governance and catastrophic risk mitigation, setting strategic direction across governance, technical research, and outreach programming.
- ❖ Replicated and extended Anthropic's emotion-vector interpretability methodology (Sofroniew et al., 2026) on the open-weight Gemma 2 2B model
- ❖ Authored a policy memo proposing reform of Virginia's data-center tax exemptions to require compute contributions for public redistribution, expanding access to AI and education infrastructure.

Principal Investigator, AR & Public History

UVA Architectural History, advised by Prof. Louis Nelson · Charlottesville, VA

May 2026 – Present

- ❖ Conducting IRB-approved research on augmented reality as a lever for public engagement with historical sites; producing a digital history project on UVA's anatomical theatre.

Education Technology Intern

mEducation Alliance · Arlington, VA

January – May 2026

- ❖ Assessed mobile STEM kit efficacy across 20+ countries through stakeholder interviews with Ministries of Education and NGOs; produced digital content for global ed-tech access campaigns.

Technology Innovation & Experimentation Intern

National Museum of African American History and Culture (NMAAHC) · Washington, D.C.

June – August 2025

- ❖ Authored white papers and policy summaries on AI regulation in cultural institutions; briefed senior executives on global AI technology trends.
- ❖ Designed and pitched an AI-enhanced visitor experience initiative adopted for further development by museum leadership.

ADVISORY & TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Student Technology Council

University of Virginia, est. by Prof. Mona Sloane (Sloane Lab, Karsh Institute of Democracy) · Charlottesville, VA

Incoming Fall 2026

- ❖ Selected as one of two class representatives to UVA's inaugural Student Technology Council, the first student body in the country advising a university on technology procurement, innovation, and AI governance.

Program Committee Member, AIES 2026

Spring 2026

- ❖ Reviewed submitted research on AI ethics, governance, and social impact for a leading interdisciplinary AI ethics conference.

Invited Panelist, K-12 Coalition Think Tank

March 2026

- ❖ Contributed practitioner-informed insights to national discussions on instructional practice, ed-tech, and professional development.

Substitute Teacher

December 2024 – December 2025

Fairfax County Public Schools · Fairfax County, VA

- ❖ Delivered instruction to diverse student populations, including English Language Learners and students with disabilities, using assistive and digital learning tools.

VOLUNTEERING

CoLab Mentor, Computers for Kids (C4K) · Event Photographer Volunteer, Jefferson School African American Heritage Center · Agricultural Volunteer, Morven Farm

HONORS & AWARDS

Robert Kent Gooch Scholarship, UVA College of Arts & Sciences — for students with qualities of mind and character considered requisite for selection of Rhodes Scholars.

Undergraduate Researcher Award, UVA Dept. of Computer Science — recognizes excellence in CS research, selected annually by faculty.

Kenan Award, UVA Office of Citizen Scholar Development — \$5,000 grant; one of five awarded university-wide for research on UVA's Academical Village.

SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

AI & Research: AI Safety & Governance, AI Research, Algorithm Design, Human Subjects Research, Qualitative Methods, White Paper & Policy Writing

Technical: Python, Java, JavaScript, HTML, Adobe Creative Suite, Google Workspace, Canva, PyTorch

Communication & Media: Graphic Design, Video Production & Editing, Photography, Newsletter Development